OSHA Fire Extinguisher Inspection Checklist (29 CFR 1910.157)

Use on the monthly extinguisher round and at the annual maintenance check.

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.157

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A.
2. If an item fails, correct it or take the unit out of service; when a unit is removed for maintenance or recharging, provide alternate equivalent protection (1910.157(e)(5)).
3. Each item names the 1910.157 paragraph it is based on; read that paragraph when a result is unclear.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1910.157: Portable fire extinguishers (Part 1910 Subpart L, Fire Protection) Source: eCFR, Title 29, section 1910.157 (text as of 2026-11-09) Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1910-157-portable-fire-extinguishers

SECTION A | Placement and access

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Approved extinguisher Ref. 1910.157(c)(2)	Only approved extinguishers are in use.	☐	☐	☐	
2	Mounting and identification Ref. 1910.157(c)(1)	Mounted, located and identified so it is readily accessible and reachable without risk of injury.	☐	☐	☐	
3	Designated place Ref. 1910.157(c)(4)	Unit is in its designated place.	☐	☐	☐	
4	Class A travel distance Ref. 1910.157(d)(2)	No employee has more than 75 feet of travel to an extinguisher for Class A fires.	☐	☐	☐	
5	Class B travel distance Ref. 1910.157(d)(4)	Travel from each Class B hazard area to an extinguisher is 50 feet or less.	☐	☐	☐	
6	Class C coverage Ref. 1910.157(d)(5)	Units for Class C hazards follow the Class A or Class B distribution pattern.	☐	☐	☐	
7	Class D coverage Ref. 1910.157(d)(6)	Class D agent within 75 feet of any area that generates combustible metal powders, flakes or shavings at least once every two weeks.	☐	☐	☐	
8	Prohibited agents Ref. 1910.157(c)(3)	No carbon tetrachloride or chlorobromomethane extinguishers on site.	☐	☐	☐	
9	Inverting-type units Ref. 1910.157(c)(5)	No soldered or riveted shell self-generating soda acid, self-generating foam or gas cartridge water units that are inverted to rupture a cartridge or start an uncontrollable pressure-generating chemical reaction.	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION B | Monthly visual inspection

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
10	Monthly inspection done Ref. 1910.157(e)(2)	Visual inspection completed this month for each extinguisher and any hose used in place of Class A units.	☐	☐	☐	
11	Charge and condition Ref. 1910.157(c)(4)	Unit is fully charged and operable.	☐	☐	☐	
12	Corrosion or damage Ref. 1910.157(f)(4)	No new corrosion or mechanical injury. A unit showing it goes for hydrostatic testing unless a condition in 1910.157(f)(2)(i)–(v) applies, such as pitting corrosion, a soldered or welded repair, or fire damage; see the next item for units unfit for testing.	☐	☐	☐	
13	Failed or unfit units Ref. 1910.157(f)(14)	No shell, cylinder or cartridge that failed a hydrostatic test or is unfit for testing remains in the workplace.	☐	☐	☐	
14	Cover during servicing Ref. 1910.157(e)(5)	Alternate equivalent protection is in place for every unit away for maintenance or recharging.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Annual maintenance and hydrostatic testing

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
15	Annual maintenance check Ref. 1910.157(e)(3)	Annual maintenance check completed within the past year.	☐	☐	☐	
16	Maintenance record Ref. 1910.157(e)(3)	Annual maintenance date recorded and the record kept for one year after the last entry or the life of the shell, whichever is less.	☐	☐	☐	
17	6-year maintenance Ref. 1910.157(e)(4)	Stored pressure dry chemical units needing a 12-year hydrostatic test emptied and maintained every 6 years (clock restarts at recharge or hydrostatic test); non-refillable disposable units exempt.	☐	☐	☐	
18	Hydrostatic test date Ref. 1910.157(f)(2)	Last hydrostatic test falls inside the Table L-1 interval for the extinguisher type (5 or 12 years).	☐	☐	☐	
19	CO2 and wheeled-unit cylinders Ref. 1910.157(f)(10)	Carbon dioxide extinguishers and wheeled-unit nitrogen or CO2 cylinders tested within 5 years, or 10 years for nitrogen cylinders complying with 49 CFR 173.34(e)(15).	☐	☐	☐	
20	Hose assemblies Ref. 1910.157(f)(5)	Hose ending in a shut-off nozzle tested on its extinguisher's interval.	☐	☐	☐	
21	Test certification record Ref. 1910.157(f)(16)	Record shows test date, tester's signature and the unit's serial number or other identifier.	☐	☐	☐	
22	Tester Ref. 1910.157(f)(1)	Tester is trained and uses suitable test equipment and facilities.	☐	☐	☐	

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SECTION D | Training

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
23	Education program Ref. 1910.157(g)(1)	Program covering general principles of extinguisher use and incipient stage fire fighting hazards is in place.	☐	☐	☐	
24	Education frequency Ref. 1910.157(g)(2)	Each employee received the education at hire and again in the last year.	☐	☐	☐	
25	Designated fire fighters Ref. 1910.157(g)(3)	Employees designated to use fire fighting equipment are trained on the equipment they would use.	☐	☐	☐	
26	Designated group refresher Ref. 1910.157(g)(4)	Designated employees trained on initial assignment and no more than a year ago.	☐	☐	☐	
27	Hose station users Ref. 1910.157(d)(3)	Where hose stations or standpipes replace Class A extinguishers, employees trained in their use during the past 12 months.	☐	☐	☐	

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE? ☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE	DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW	DATE / TIME